

EDUCATIONPLUS

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Ponmythili Muralidharan

During exam season, certain things repeat themselves in almost every home. A student sitting at the dining table late into the night. A cup of tea gone cold. Notes spread out, not always being read. A parent hovering nearby, unsure whether to speak or stay silent.

From the outside, it looks like stress. From the inside, it feels like learning something that no textbook ever names. During this time, students often answer the same question again and again.

“How are you?”
“I’m fine.”

It is said while tying shoelaces in a hurry, while eating without much appetite, or while stepping out of the exam hall and avoiding eye contact. Often, “I’m fine” means I’m managing.

Beyond textbooks

Exams do not only test what students know. They slowly train students to stay with effort. To sit with discomfort without walking away. To return to the same chapter even when confidence dips and motivation feels thin.

Many students remember this phase not because of a particular question, but because of how it felt. The heaviness in the chest before an exam. The strange quiet of



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Life lessons from exams

With exam season upon us, an educator reflects on what students actually learn and carry forward from this period of stress

the hall. The moment of doubt halfway through a paper when the mind goes blank and yet the hand keeps moving. That moment matters.

After the exam, the managing does not stop. Outside the hall, conversations begin quickly.

“That question was easy,” or “I think the answer is option C.”

Some students listen and feel unsettled. Some

quietly walk away. Some put on earphones even if no music is playing. Choosing not to participate in these conversations takes effort. It is not avoidance. It is self-control, and many students practise it daily during exam season.

Two students can score the same marks and yet come away with very different inner experiences. One may have

had reassurance at home, steady encouragement, and the sense that outcomes were not the only thing being watched. Another may have carried unspoken pressure. The fear of letting someone down. The feeling that failure was not an option.

Manage responsibility
What exams reveal quietly is not who is

smarter, but who learns to carry responsibility early.

Most students learn this without anyone spelling it out. They learn how to manage tiredness. How to keep going even when sleep is patchy and days blur into each other. How to hold their nerves when comparison enters the room through rank lists, coaching centre stories, or a relative’s ca-

sual comment.

They also learn how to appear fine. Many students become experts at saying “I’m okay” even when they are not. They learn that discipline is admired, but doubt is inconvenient. That calm is appreciated, but questions about fear or fatigue are harder to place. Over time, composure becomes a habit. This is not a weakness. It is an adaptation.

What often makes the difference is whether this effort is seen. When a parent notices persistence instead of only marks, the strain feels meaningful. When effort is invisible, pressure feels heavier than it needs to be.

Most adults can trace something important back to their exam years. The first time they realised they could do something difficult without quitting. The first time, they understood what sustained effort felt like. The first time they learned that clarity does not always come before action, sometimes it comes after. These lessons did not stay in school. They travelled forward.

Many adults forget this. They remember the stress, but not the strength it built. Yet the ability to sit with discomfort, to stay with effort, and to continue without immediate clarity was learned much earlier than they realise. Often, it was first practised during exam season.

Training ground

That is why exam pressure should not be spoken about only as suffering. It is also a training ground. Not because pressure is good in itself, but because learning to hold pressure with dignity builds something lasting.

Support during exam season does not mean removing difficulty. It means making the difficulty feel held. It shows up in small ways. In reducing unnecessary comparisons. In recognising effort even on days when results are unclear. In allowing a student to say, “This is hard”, without immediately trying to fix it.

Exams will end. Papers will be corrected. Life will move on. What stays is quieter. The memory of having stood in that heat and endured. The knowledge that, even at a young age, one learned to carry responsibility and finish what was started. Later, when life demands rigour again – as it will – something familiar returns. A sense of alignment.

I have done this before. I have stayed with something difficult before. If I could do it then, I can do it now. That is what exams do not test, but what students carry forward.

The writer is Junior Faculty Organisation - Behaviour and Human Resource at Great Lakes Institute of Management, Chennai.

SCHOLARSHIPS

Vivo Kanya Gyaan Scholarship

A CSR initiative by vivo India.
Eligibility: Women students in the first or second year of a full-time, regular STEM UG course at NIRF-ranked colleges and have scored at least 70% in Classes 10 and 12 and in the most recent academic year and have an annual family income not exceeding ₹500,000. Preference will be given to students from government colleges. Students who are receiving other financial aid are not eligible.
Rewards: ₹60,000 a year
Application: Online
Deadline: March 3
www.b4s.in/edge/VKGSP1

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Provided by the CSIR-Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology.
Eligibility: Students in the first year of M.Sc., M.Tech or M.Pharm, or those in B.Tech., B.Pharm, or Integrated Science and Technology programmes, MBBS BDS or B.Sc. Bioscience.
Rewards: Research experience and mentorship .
Application: Online
Deadline: March 10
www.b4s.in/edge/CCMB2

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An initiative of the Government of Ireland, in partnership with the Irish HEIs and managed by the Higher Education Authority.
Eligibility: Open to domiciled residents of non-EU/EEA countries who are graduates and hold a conditional or final admission offer to an Irish institution at the time of application.
Rewards: Up to €10,000 for a year.
Application: Online
Deadline: March 12
www.b4s.in/edge/ITES2

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com



OFF THE EDGE
Nandini Raman

I am in Class 10. I am interested in a career in fashion and am considering applying to NIIFT. I also see myself as an entrepreneur one day. Which stream should I choose for Class 11? Is engineering a stable backup option? What other career paths will align with my interests and provide security? Srihita

Dear Srihita,
Humanities or Commerce would be a suitable choice in Class 11. Maths is optional, not mandatory. A NIIFT degree opens doors to roles such as fashion designer, stylist, visual merchandiser, costume designer, brand manager, merchandiser, luxury retail manager, and so on. Many graduates also launch their own labels or pursue global opportunities and higher studies abroad.
Engineering is a stable backup only if you genuinely enjoy it. It requires Pure Sciences in Classes 11 and 12 and has little overlap with fashion or entrepreneurship. Pursuing it without interest can lead to burnout. Smarter backup options aligned with your goals include B.Des., BBA, BMS, or B.Com, followed by an MBA in Fashion, Luxury, Retail, or Entrepreneurship. Fields like Graphic Design, UI/UX, Product Design, and Communication Design also offer strong creative career pathways. Liberal Arts degrees in Design Studies, Media and Communication, Psychology, Marketing, or Cultural Studies can prepare you for branding, consumer insights, and creative business roles.

Meet a career counsellor for professional profiling to understand your strengths and align them with the right path.

Career crossroads

Uncertain about your career options? Low on self-confidence? This column may help

I finished B.Com. in 2019 and worked for a daily wage while preparing for the government exams. Now, at 28, I am unemployed, lack any experience certificate and don’t know what to do. Aswin

Dear Aswin,
The key is a structured re-entry plan and a skills upgrade. Accounting and Finance support roles may be the quickest entry points. Target positions such as Accounts Executive, Accounts Assistant, Billing Executive, Junior Accountant, or MIS Executive. Get certified in Tally, GST, and basic Excel. Apply to CA firms, SMEs, hospitals, schools, logistics companies, and start-ups. You can also consider roles like Relationship Officer, Operations Executive, Back Office Executive, or Loan Processing Executive in private banks, NBFCs, and fintech firms.
If you prefer a fresh direction, explore digital marketing (especially performance marketing and analytics) or supply chain and operations support. Short certifications and internships can help you transition. Highlight skill certificates, internships, freelance work, projects, and references in your applications. During interviews, explain how you used your time while preparing for exams.

I am pursuing a B.E. from a tier-3 college and aim to secure jobs in Software Development or Full Stack Development. I also want to work part-time as a real-time information provider on social issues,

based on knowledge gained from newspaper reading and books. How can I do this? Navya

Dear Navya,
Prioritise your Software/Full-Stack career first, as that will fund everything else. Let your social-impact work complement, not distract from, your core goal. Choose one employable path and avoid choosing too many. Build a few strong projects — a CRUD app with authentication, a real-world dashboard using public APIs, and one project linked to a social issue — and deploy them using platforms like Vercel, Netlify, or Render. Your GitHub should show consistency and real work. Next, apply for internships at start-ups via Wellfound and LinkedIn. Even short or unpaid internships can strengthen your profile.
For social issues, pick one niche and build content consistently. Over time, this can become your portfolio and networking tool. Maintain an active LinkedIn presence, post weekly insights, and join open-source communities, developer forums, and local tech meetups.

I am a B.Sc. Maths graduate doing M.Sc. Statistics and preparing for the banking exams. But I am not sure if that is the right fit. What are my options in trading and finance after my M.Sc. in India and abroad? What other skills do I need? Melvin

Dear Melvin,
A B.Sc. in Maths and M.Sc. in Statistics is highly valued in finance. Most banking roles lead to operations,

compliance, retail banking, and administrative functions, where your mathematical and analytical strengths may be underused. If you enjoy data, probability, markets, and problem-solving, finance and trading are better aligned.

After your post-graduation, look for roles such as Junior Trader, Quantitative Analyst, Risk Analyst, and Market Analyst across proprietary firms, brokerages, and hedge funds. Overseas roles in quant trading, research, and financial engineering may require further specialisation.
Quantitative Finance and Financial Engineering are especially strong fits with roles such as Quantitative Analyst, Model Validation Analyst, Derivatives Pricing Analyst, and Risk Modelling Professional.

You could also explore financial data science (fraud analytics, credit scoring, and algo-trading support), actuarial science, or policy and research roles in think tanks and central banks. Build skills in Python (essential), SQL, advanced Excel, derivatives, portfolio theory, and risk metrics. Certifications like CFA, FRM, CQF, or NSE can further strengthen your profile.

Disclaimer: This column is merely a guiding voice and provides advice and suggestions on education and careers.

The writer is a practising counsellor and a trainer. Send your questions to eduplus.thehindu@gmail.com with the subject line Off the Edge

Clarification: With regard to an answer published in the February 23 issues, some readers were upset by my use of the term ‘financial cushion’ with reference to the JRF stipend. I would like to clarify that what I meant was that the JRF provides some financial stability for the questioner to pursue Ph.D. and study for the State PSC exams and not to misuse the funds.



REEPIK

From blueprint to blackboard

The success of NEP 2020 depends less on the ambition of its ideas and more on the strength of its execution.

Vipin Benny

More than five years after the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 was unveiled, India’s higher education system is no longer merely preparing for reform but experiencing it. As universities and colleges actively implement policy directives related to multidisciplinary education, flexible degree structures, digital learning, and outcome-based teaching, it is becoming clear that the success of the policy depends less on the ambition of its ideas and more on the strength of its execution.

The current phase of implementation coincides with a period of heightened higher education expectations – students and parents seek employability, relevance, and global competitiveness. Institutions are under pressure to modernise curricula and adopt digital platforms. Teachers are expected to transform pedagogical approaches while balancing administrative demands. Thus, the NEP 2020 offers a chance to correct long-standing structural rigidities, while exposing institutional

gaps, capacity constraints, and uneven preparedness across regions. Understanding this tension between policy vision and practical reality is essential to achieving the transformative promise.

Teacher at the core

At the heart of implementation lies the teacher, the classroom and the educator. Teachers are the primary interpreters of policy, translating abstract reforms into concrete learning experiences. The shift towards multidisciplinary curricula, flexible credit systems, and continuous assessment has altered how teaching is planned and delivered. In many colleges, faculty members are redesigning courses, integrating digital tools, and encouraging experiential learning. These changes are gradually moving education away from rote learning towards critical-thinking and application-oriented outcomes.

However, many educators are navigating reform amid unclear guidelines, compressed timelines, and expanding workloads. The introduction of new academic structures often runs parallel to existing administrative responsibilities,

leaving limited space for reflection and innovation. In institutions with inadequate digital infrastructure or limited access to training, teachers are forced to learn through trial and error. While some adapt creatively, others view compliance as an additional burden rather than as a professional opportunity.

In several institutions, educators are responding to constraints with resilience and experimenting with blended learning, collaborative teaching, and alternative assessment methods. This shows that, when teachers perceive reforms as meaningful and achievable, they are willing to invest effort in change. So, educator engagement is not a fixed trait but a response shaped by the conditions under which reform is introduced.

At ground level

If educators are the drivers of reform, institutions are the systems that enable or constrain their actions. Colleges that have invested in faculty development, digital infrastructure, and academic autonomy have experienced smoother transitions. In such places, reforms are planned, con-

textualised, and sustained. Teachers receive training, are encouraged to experiment, leadership communicates expectations clearly, and experimentation is encouraged rather than penalised.

In contrast, institutions that treat implementation as a compliance exercise struggle to effect meaningful change. Where support systems are weak, reforms tend to be fragmented: new curricula without training, digital platforms without infrastructure, and assessment reforms without workload rationalisation. This has led to uneven outcomes across India’s higher education landscape.

Therefore, the current situation demands recalibration of reform priorities. Policymakers and regulators must recognise that institutional capacity-building is not secondary to reform but central to it. Investment in training, mentoring, and infrastructure is a prerequisite for success. Equally important is granting institutions the flexibility to adapt the frameworks to their local contexts rather than enforcing uniform models across diverse settings.

As NEP 2020 enters its next phase, the emphasis must shift from announcing reforms to deepening their foundations to ensure sustainability. Strengthening institutional ecosystems, supporting educators through transitions, and reducing administrative ambiguity will determine whether the NEP becomes a transformative milestone or a missed opportunity.

Ultimately, education reform succeeds when capacity is matched by capacity and intent is supported by action. The NEP 2020 provided the vision. The task now is to ensure that classrooms are equipped to realise this.

The writer is a Research Consultant, Assistant Professor, and Research Supervisor at St. Thomas College (Autonomous), Thrissur, Kerala.

Sorabh Bajaj

Artificial Intelligence (AI) delivers what machines have always excelled at: repetitive, rule-based tasks executed at inhuman speed and scale. A skill is, by definition, learnable and repeatable. If it can be systematised, documented, and taught to one person, it can eventually be taught to an algorithm. Coding, data analysis, financial forecasting, legal research, and medical diagnostics – technical competencies once considered highly specialised – now face automation pressure. This is not dystopian; it is inevitable and, ultimately, liberating.

Distinctly human

What machines cannot do or what no algorithm can replicate is thinking. Not processing, but thinking. Not pattern-matching, but meaning-making. Not optimisation, but imagination. Critical thinking remains distinctly human. Machines can only summarise what we know, but humans can imagine what we don't.

Ethical reasoning, the capacity to navigate moral complexity and make decisions grounded in values rather than mere data, requires lived experience and empathy that no code can generate. Adaptability also emerges from understanding context, culture, and the messy unpredictability of the real world. These cognitive capabilities cannot be automated because they are not me-



Be human

Students must be equipped not with skills that algorithms will inevitably master, but with the capacity to think, question, imagine, and lead

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chanical. They are human.

This is precisely where education plays a pivotal role. Since skills alone can be automated, an education system focused narrowly on skill acquisition risks preparing students for a world that no longer exists. The real challenge, and opportunity, lies in nurturing thinkers: indi-

viduals who can connect ideas across domains, ask better questions, interpret nuance, and apply judgment in real-world contexts.

This approach of an interdisciplinary education model, along with experiential learning, will be central to preparing our students and future lead-

ers for an AI-driven world.

Many mistake interdisciplinary learning with simply studying multiple subjects; however, it is much more than that. It is about learning to integrate multiple perspectives. The most complex challenges of our time – climate change, public health, digital ethics, economic inequality, or

the future of work – sit at the intersections of technology, society, policy, culture, and human behaviour. An interdisciplinary education model equips students to navigate these intersections with intellectual agility. When a student trained in economics engages deeply with sociology, psychology, design, or data science, they begin to see problems not as isolated variables but as interconnected systems.

This capacity to synthesise knowledge across domains is what differentiates thinking from mere skill execution. An AI system may optimise a supply chain, but cannot fully grasp the social consequences of labour displacement. It may analyse voter data, but cannot meaningfully weigh democratic values, historical context, and ethical responsibility. Interdisciplinary thinking cultivates precisely this ability to balance analysis with judgment, logic with empathy, and efficiency with purpose.

Experiential learning

What is equally important is nurturing the depth of thinking in our students, which comes from lived experience. Experiential learning thus plays a critical role in helping students move beyond abstract knowledge to embodied understanding. Through immersive projects, internships, fieldwork, and community engagement, students encounter complexity as it exists outside the classroom: messy,

unpredictable, and deeply human. This is where critical thinking is truly forged. Further, when students work with communities, organisations, or global institutions, they are required to confront perspectives different from their own, question assumptions, and adapt their thinking in real time. Such experiences cannot be simulated by AI. They demand presence, reflection, emotional intelligence, and moral reasoning.

Initiatives such as study abroad programmes, having global visiting faculty, collaborating on joint research opportunities with international institutions, or even developing curriculum design with international experts expose students to a global environment and reinforce interdisciplinary thinking.

This shift towards developing capacities that define human excellence is crucial, and educators must challenge students to interrogate information and to imagine futures that current industries have not yet conceived.

As we await the future's unfolding, we must equip this generation not with skills that algorithms will inevitably master, but with the capacity to think, to question, to imagine, and to lead; not to compete with machines at mechanical tasks, but to harness machines as tools while they do what only humans can do: envision and shape the future.

The writer is Director, Centre for Digital Learning, FLAME University.

Beyond the gym

A Fitness Innovation Coach integrates exercise science, technology, and human insight to help people stay fit and healthy



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Richa Mishra

The fitness industry is going through a subtle change. Fitness is no longer a mere weightlifting or calorie-burning activity; it is a comprehensive understanding of the body, mind, and total wellness. As a result, the fitness professional has to use an integration of exercise science, technology, and human insight to improve efficiency and sustainability in training.

Earlier, fitness coaching was mostly about exercise routines, reps, and physical performance. Now, one needs to be aware of an even broader ecosystem that encompasses recovery, stress, sleep, posture, mobility, and injury prevention. AFitness Innovation Coach not only gathers data from wearables and tests to decide the workout plan but also depends on seeing, talking, and being empathetic.

With fitness increasingly being recognised as an integral part of preventive healthcare and lifestyle management, trainers need to provide a scientific explanation of how an exercise works, how the body changes, and when adjustments should be made.

Educational pathways

A strong educational foundation helps fitness professionals design safe and effective programmes; work with diverse populations and age groups; understand injury risks and movement limitations; interpret basic health and performance data; and communicate clearly and responsibly with clients. Students interested in this field can explore multiple learning pathways:

Formal Education: Degrees or diplomas in Sports Science, Physical Education, Physiotherapy, Exercise Science, Human Movement, or Health Sciences are an excellent source of theoretical knowledge. Through these programmes, students become familiar with the

structure and function of the human body, its mechanical aspects, the physiological processes, and the principles of rehabilitation.

Professional Certifications: Globally recognised fitness certifications are the means by which one can change theoretical knowledge into practical application. These certifications put a great deal of emphasis on exercise programming, assessment, and coaching methodology. Additionally, they familiarise the learners with current industry standards.

Continuous Education: As the field keeps changing, continuous education is a must to remain relevant. Short-term certifications in functional training, mobility, corrective exercise, recovery techniques, or data-informed coaching help in this regard..

Skills required

Academic knowledge alone is not enough. A successful Fitness Innovation Coach also develops a range of practical and soft skills, including clear communication and listening skills; analytical thinking and problem solving, basic understanding of technology and fitness tracking tools, emotional intelligence and client empathy, discipline, adaptability, and ethical responsibility. These allow coaches to tailor training, create trust, and facilitate sustainable behaviour change.

As awareness of health issues related to lifestyle has increased, fitness professionals are being regarded as educators and guides. Fitness Innovation Coaches can be found in different settings such as gyms, wellness platforms, corporate health programmes, sports, and community-based initiatives, where they play a significant role in raising awareness and promoting a preventive health approach.

The writer is VP-Operations, Anytime Fitness India

S. Alfred Cecil Raj

As educational systems worldwide grapple with the demands of digital transformation, Virtual Labs (VLabs) offer solutions that are both pedagogically sound and economically viable. In the Indian context, where educational access and quality remain critical concerns, they provide scalable, cost-effective and inclusive solutions that can improve educational outcomes.

Significance

VLab platforms simulate real-world laboratory environments, enabling students to conduct experiments, manipulate variables, and observe outcomes through sophisticated computer simulations and remote-controlled equipment. Their significance extends beyond mere technological innovation. They represent a fundamental re-imagining of how educational institutions can deliver quality learning experiences while addressing persistent challenges such as resource constraints, geographical barriers and scalability issues.

Experiment virtually

Integrating VLabs into educational strategies in school and college equips students with strong theoretical foundations and practical skills

The Government of India, through its NME-ICT, launched the Virtual Labs (VLE) project in 2012 and introduced 91 virtual laboratories encompassing hundreds of experiments across nine disciplines of Science and Engineering. Through platforms like DIKSHA and partnerships with higher education institutions, the Ministry of Education is rolling out large-scale virtual labs for both schools and colleges. These initiatives target diverse subjects, from Science and Engineering to Computer Science and vocational skills.

The VLab portal (vlab.co.in) hosts a vast repository of experiments across a wide array of subjects. These are available completely free of charge to students, faculty and enthusiasts across the country and the globe and require only a standard internet connection. The

platform offers different VLabs experiences to cater to various learning objectives, namely (a) Simulation and Modelling-Based Labs, (b) Measurement-Based Labs and (c) Remote-Triggered Labs.

OBE goals

Exploiting VLabs to ascertain the goals of Outcome-Based Education (OBE) is a highly effective strategy. VLabs, with their interactive and data-rich environments, are uniquely positioned to facilitate and measure the specified outcomes. To best exploit VLabs for OBE, institutions must view them not as a simple repository of experiments, but as a comprehensive ecosystem for learning and assessment.

By strategically mapping experiments to outcomes, using them to facilitate problem-solving and leveraging their powerful data analytics for assessment,



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such as the number of attempts, accuracy of results, speed and process adherence, educators can effectively measure outcome attainment at both the individual and class level. This data supports continuous improvement of the learner and provides the objective evidence required for modern accreditation and, more importantly, ensures that students are graduating with demonstrable skills needed for their future careers.

VLabs do not totally replace traditional laboratories, but are an influential supporting alternative. In particular, they make it possible to perform difficult and expensive tests

and experiments in a more economical manner. Experiments that may require more time can be visualised in a few minutes in the VLab environment, or present points that may be neglected or missed. Thus, it offers 24/7 availability and self-paced learning, is inclusive of students with disabilities, fosters a safe and fearless learning environment, and enhances pedagogical effectiveness and conceptual understanding.

Blended model

For both schools and colleges, the most effective path forward is not a complete replacement of physical labs with virtual ones, but a blended model. At

the school level, VLabs can be used to introduce concepts safely and equitably, sparking interest and providing foundational knowledge before students handle simple, safe equipment in a physical setting. In colleges, VLabs should be used as a powerful supplement: for pre-lab preparation, for post-lab data analysis and to provide access to experiments on equipment that is too expensive or dangerous for a standard teaching lab. The core hands-on skills and troubleshooting experience must still be gained in a physical laboratory.

It is important to highlight that VLab programmes are most effective when integrated into educational strategies that emphasise collaborative learning and a constructivist approach. By thoughtfully merging the advantages of these methods, educators can develop richer, safer and more impactful learning environments, equipping students with both strong theoretical foundations and practical skills for real-world application.

The writer is the Director, Faculty Development Centre, St. Joseph's College (Autonomous), Tiruchi.



THINK
Aruna
Sankaranarayanan

While fragmented and dwindling attention spans are often discussed today, another human quality that is also on the wane receives far less attention: the old-fashioned virtue of patience or the willingness to wait without getting flustered. Just as devices have squandered our ability to focus, they have also perpetuated a need for constant stimulation. This, in turn, makes us antsy and impatient when

we have to wait, take turns, or simply have nothing to do. It is evident even as we interact with our devices. How many of us get irked when a website is slow to load?

In an article in *Psyche*, Matt Huston unpacks the psychology of impatience. He cites a study conducted by Annabella Roberts and Ayelet



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Patience pays

We are now used to getting things at the click of a button and so our capacity to wait has eroded

Fishbach that examined people's impatience, as they waited in diverse contexts. These involved knowing the results of the 2020 US presidential election, the first public release of the COVID-19 vaccine, and simply waiting for a bus to arrive. In the first two situations, people's impatience escalated the closer they seemed to getting what they were waiting for.

Likewise, for those waiting for a bus, their impatience increased if they thought the bus was just about to arrive, even if they hadn't been waiting for very long.

Desire to finish

The researchers attribute this "swelling impatience" towards the "end of the wait" to the desire to finish an activity and move on to the next. You might have experienced this "goal-gradient effect" when you were completing a lengthy report or taking part in a race. When the end is in sight, you are motivated by a burst of

energy to get the job done. However, when you are simply waiting for a bus or a table at a restaurant, there's not much you can do to accelerate things. So, your "eagerness to act" or "get closure" gets transmuted into a restless energy that's called impatience.

Effect on health

Experiencing impatience on a regular basis has tangible effects on our health. In a post on his website, Professor R.J. Starr writes that chronic impatience increases your "risk for hypertension and cardiovascular issues". Further, it can hamper our relationships with people. If you signal irritation, as a friend hems and haws before getting to the point, you may exacerbate your friend's stress and miss out on the opportunity to have a meaningful

exchange.

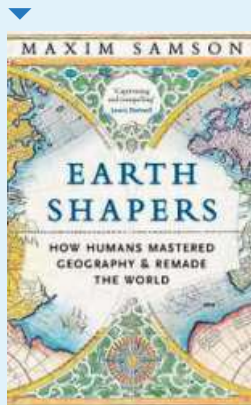
Starr believes that technological shifts and our dependence on devices have contributed to our rising impatience. Because we are now used to getting things at the click of a button, be it information or entertainment, our capacity to wait has eroded. As e-commerce has also expedited the shopping process, we get antsy if a pizza is not delivered within the stated time window.

Recently, the Indian government put a stop to the 10-minute delivery option on e-commerce websites in the interests of the safety of gig workers who went on strike in December 2025. With e-commerce growing at a rapid rate, companies lure customers with shorter and shorter delivery windows, which are a reflection of our growing impatience.

Observe any public space where people are waiting – a bus stop or a doctor's clinic. People are tethered to their devices. As a result, we don't have blank spaces in our lives when we simply do nothing. Prof. Starr recommends that, when we have a spare moment, we may desist from the urge to pick up our phones, which now serve as adult pacifiers. Instead, allow yourself to practice mindfulness or gratitude or simply observe the sights, sounds and smells that surround you. Cultivating patience fosters "emotional resilience," says Prof Starr. He also reminds us that patience is a choice we can exercise, both in mundane and momentous moments.

The writer is visiting faculty at the School of Education, Azim Premji University, Bengaluru, and the co-author of Bee-Witched.

ON THE SHELF



Earth Shapers

Mountains, meridians, rivers and borders carve up the world on our maps and in our minds. But geography is not set in stone. This book explores how we mould the world around us and how, as we etch our needs onto the natural landscape, we alter the course of history.

Author: Maxim Samson
Publisher: Hachette
Price: ₹ 999